

Mixture viscosity measurement

W26 (2026) — English translation

This problem examines the dependence of the viscosity of a mixture of glycerol and water on temperature and their relative concentration. Viscosity is the ability of a liquid to resist flow. The more viscous the liquid, the more difficult it is to pump it through pipes, which means there is a need to use more powerful pumps and stronger pipes designed for higher pressure.

Note for data processing

There are several ways to solve equations numerically. The simple iteration method (SI) is one of the simplest methods for numerically solving equations. It is convenient to use it for numerically finding quantities that are given implicitly as a solution to some equation. To solve an equation using the MPI, it must be represented in the form

$$x = f(x). \quad (1)$$

Substituting the initial approximation x_0 as an argument to the function, we obtain the first approximation x_1 . Further, substituting x_1 as an argument to the function, we obtain the second approximation x_2 , etc. The function $f(x)$ can always be chosen so that the difference between successive approximations decreases, and the result of the calculations becomes closer to the correct answer. To do this, it is necessary that in a sufficiently large neighborhood of the correct answer, the derivative of the function $f(x)$ is less than one in absolute value. If this is not the case, the easiest way is to redefine $f(x)$:

$$f(x) \rightarrow ax + (1 - a)f(x).$$

This transformation is invariant under equation (1) and in practice almost always achieves convergence with proper selection of $a \in \mathbb{R}$. Since the calculator uses the variable Ans to store the intermediate value, a practical implementation of the MPI is to set Ans equal to the initial guess and start calculating $f(\text{Ans})$ many times. With the correct selection of the function $f(x)$ the result of the calculations will quickly converge to the correct answer. Another popular method for numerically solving equations is the segment division method. The most common way to do this is to divide the segment in half. The essence of the method is to successively reduce the segment within which the desired solution to the equation lies. To do this, at each iteration this segment is divided into equal parts, the left and right sides of the equation are calculated at the resulting points, and the one on which the difference between the left and right sides changes sign is selected as a new segment. The midpoint of the segment is usually chosen as an estimate for the root. One of the options for the practical implementation of dividing a segment is to use the Table mode, which is supported by some models of calculators. This mode allows you to calculate the values of a given function with equal steps within a given argument range. Typically, the calculator's memory is enough to calculate the function at about 20–25 points, so at each iteration you can effectively divide the segment by about 20 times.

Introduction

For a mixture of water and glycerol, the dependence of the glass transition temperature on the mass fraction of glycerol w_g can be described with good accuracy by the polynomial:

$$T_g(K) = 140.3 + 35.272w_g - 3.879w_g^2 + 23.467w_g^3. \quad (2)$$

Using this expression and knowing the glass transition temperature, the concentration value can be determined by simple iteration.

Consider the following numerical data to be known:

- Density of glycerol at $T = 25^\circ\text{C}$: $\rho_g = 1260 \text{ kg/m}^3$;
- Density of water: $\rho_w = 1000 \text{ kg/m}^3$;
- Molar mass of glycerol: $\mu_g = 92 \text{ g/mol}$;
- Molar mass of water: $\mu_w = 18 \text{ g/mol}$.

In all parts of the problem, you may take the volume of a mixture to be equal to the sum of the volumes of the components of this mixture.

Part A. Dependence of viscosity on concentration (3.5 points)

In the general case, it is not possible to solve the problem of the viscosity of a mixture of substances; however, for a mixture of water and glycerol one can use the empirical formula

$$\eta = \xi \cdot \frac{\exp(-kn_w)}{1 + a \cdot \exp(bn_w)}.$$

The table shows the experimental dependence of the viscosity of a mixture of glycerol and water on the glass transition temperature. The measurements were carried out at a temperature of $T = 25^\circ\text{C}$.

$T_g, \text{ K}$	$\eta, \text{ Pa}\cdot\text{s}$
195.2	0.9060
194.8	0.8390
194.6	0.7670
193.9	0.6550
193.1	0.5580
191.8	0.4790
190.8	0.3730
188.6	0.2020
183.4	0.0674
173.0	0.0278
170.0	0.0134
154.6	0.0026
149.3	0.0017
143.8	0.0012
140.3	0.0009

A1	Express the mole fraction of water n_w in solution in terms of the mass fraction of glycerol w_g , μ_w and μ_g .	0.20
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A2	Using the equation (1), convert the values of T_g to the values of w_g .	1.50
A3	Propose a linearization that describes a system with a small mole fraction of water, which can be used to determine the parameters ξ and k . Plot the linearized relationship. Determine the parameters ξ and k using the resulting graph.	0.60
A4	Knowing the parameters ξ and k , propose a linearization that allows you to determine the values of the parameters a and b . Plot the linearized relationship. Using the straight section, determine a and b .	0.50
A5	Draw a graph of the theoretical and experimental dependence $\eta(n_w)$ on one piece of graph paper. Indicate the range of applicability of the resulting equation.	0.70

Part B. How does viscosity depend on temperature? (1.9 points)

At low temperatures close to the glass transition temperature, it is convenient to use the Vogel-Tammann-Fulcher (VTF) equation:

$$\eta = \eta_0 \cdot \exp\left(\frac{DT_0}{T - T_0}\right)$$

to describe the dependence of viscosity η on temperature T , where η_0 and T_0 are constants, D is a constant inversely proportional to the fragility of the substance. The value D is positive for all substances. The table shows the experimental dependence of the mixture viscosity on temperature. Measurements were made with a mixture with a volume fraction of glycerol $c_g = 0.5$.

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$T, ^\circ\text{C}$	$\eta, \text{Pa}\cdot\text{s}$
1	0.0201
4	0.0173
11	0.0128
15	0.0104
35	0.0046
44	0.0034
50	0.0031
56	0.0026
60	0.0022
67	0.0020
71	0.0017
76	0.00145
85	0.0013
90	0.0011
96	0.0010
100	0.0009

B1	Using the equation (2), determine the glass transition temperature of the solution.	0.40
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Now accept $\eta_0 = 3.33 \cdot 10^{-6} \text{ Pa} \cdot \text{s}$.

B2	Propose a linearization to determine the values of the parameters D and T_0 . By plotting a linearized relationship or using the least squares method (OLS), determine the parameter values.	1.50
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Part C. Determination of viscosity by different methods (0.8 points)

In this part of the problem, it is proposed to find the numerical value of the viscosity of the mixture using two previously obtained dependencies. To be able to compare the results obtained, in both cases the mixture is under the same conditions.

C1	Determine the viscosity of the mixture η_n at the volume fraction of glycerol $c_g = 0.5$ and temperature $T = 25^\circ \text{C}$ using the dependence on the mole fraction of water.	0.30
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C2	Determine the viscosity of the mixture η_t under the same conditions using the temperature dependence.	0.30
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C3	Compare your results. If there are discrepancies, explain the reason for them.	0.20
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Part D. Flow of a viscous mixture (3.8 points)

In addition to reducing viscosity, fluid flow can be improved by using a superhydrophobic surface. Such surfaces are not wetted by water: the drops on them remain in the form of a ball. An air gap, a plastron, appears between a rough hydrophobic surface of a certain type and the liquid, which reduces the contact area of the two media and facilitates flow. Scientists led by Maja Vuckovac from Aalto University studied the interactions of a rough superhydrophobic surface with thick liquids. The researchers constructed vertical capillaries from a commercially available superhydrophobic material (Hydrobead), closed on one or both sides. These capillaries were filled with liquids of different viscosities, including water, glycerin and polyethylene glycol, which then flowed down under the influence of gravity. As a result, physicists discovered that in this configuration, the flow is faster, the higher the viscosity. To explain the phenomenon, the researchers introduced tracker particles into liquids and began observing flowing droplets at the micro level, including flows within the droplet itself. It turned out that in droplets with low and medium viscosity, an asymmetric circular flow occurs, as if inside the bottle water flowed from the bottom to the neck along one wall and back along the other. The thicker the liquid, the weaker this effect, therefore, if the viscosities are too high, liquids in hydrophilic and hydrophobic capillaries behave the same.

Fig.1. Liquid flow under a microscope

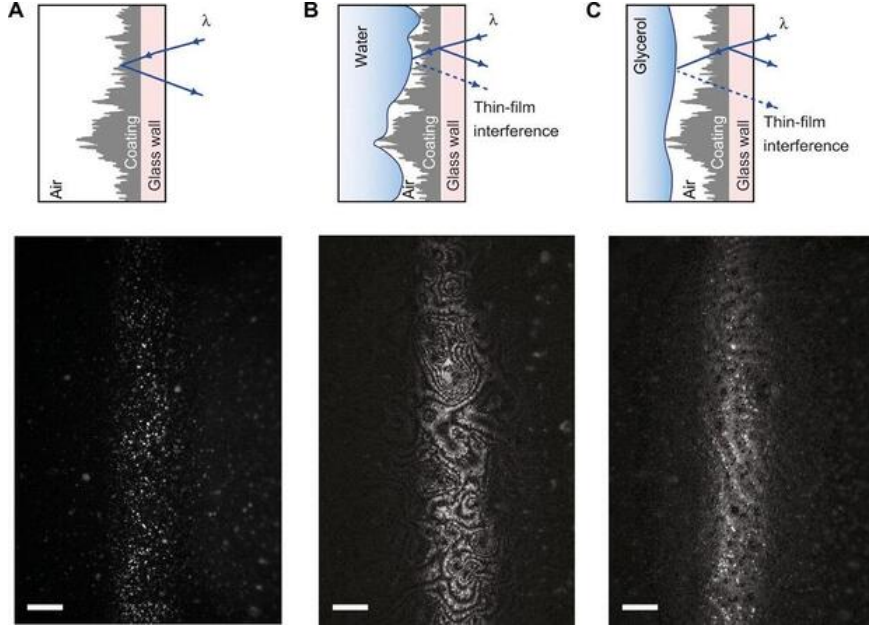


Figure 1: Figure 1.

The following experiment used 2 identical cylindrical capillaries, one of which had a smooth surface and the other hydrophobic. A mixture of water and glycerol flows through these capillaries. In the case of a hydrophilic capillary, the dependence of the volumetric flow rate of liquid on viscosity is represented by the equation:

$$Q = \frac{\pi r^4 \Delta P}{8\eta L},$$

where r is the radius of the capillary, L is its length, $\Delta P = \rho g L$ is the pressure difference at the ends of the capillary, ρ is the density of the mixture. All parameters except the viscosity and density of the mixture are maintained constant and identical for both capillaries. You can use the equation relating the viscosity of the mixture and the molar concentration of water obtained in part A, assuming that the temperatures of the mixtures in parts A and D are the same. The density of the mixture is not constant because the concentrations of glycerin in the mixture are different, however, at $\eta > \xi$, consider the density of the mixture to be equal to the density of glycerin $\rho = \rho_g$. The dependences of flow rates in a hydrophobic capillary $v_1(\eta)$ and in a hydrophilic one - $v_2(\eta)$ were obtained. The data obtained is presented in the table below:

η , Pa·s	v_1 , $\mu\text{m/s}$	v_2 , mm/s
0.95	42.5	649
1.18	48.6	602
1.32	50.3	545
1.92	80.3	408
2.41	98.0	310
3.95	152	285
5.81	182	253
13.2	243	185
18.4	255	24.8
293	72.3	388
78.0	403	224
510	515	553
989	594	1400
652	—	—

D1	Restore the missing values v_2 in the table. Use the linearized dependence graph $v_2(\eta)$ for this. Use the empty table columns on the answer sheet to convert the required values.	2.00
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You can now restore dependency $v_1(\eta)$. This dependence has several characteristic features at very different (differing by several orders of magnitude) viscosity values, which makes graphical analysis of this dependence difficult.

D2	Construct a graph of $v_1(\eta)$ in the range from $\eta_1 = 10^{-3} \text{ Pa} \cdot \text{s}$ to $\eta_2 = 10^3 \text{ Pa} \cdot \text{s}$ in the coordinates that are most convenient for graphical analysis. All points plotted on the graph must be tabulated on the answer sheet.	1.50
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D3	Determine the value of the mixture viscosity η_{max} such that the value $v_2(\eta_{max})$ is maximum.	0.30
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Source: <https://pho.rs/p/4652>